

FOR MAC • TAKES ABOUT 10 MINUTES, MOSTLY WAITING

Talk instead of type.

Whisper Flow is a free dictation app for your Mac: hold a key, speak, and your words appear typed wherever your cursor is — email, Slack, docs, anything. It's a private alternative to apps like Wispr Flow.

- 100% private — runs entirely on your Mac, nothing you say is ever sent anywhere

1 CHECK YOU'RE ON THE RIGHT KIND OF MAC

Apple silicon only (M1, M2, M3 or M4)

Click the Apple menu (top-left) → About This Mac. If it says Chip: Apple M1/M2/M3/M4, you're good. If it says Intel, this won't run — let Niall know and stop here.

2 INSTALL OLLAMA (THE ENGINE THAT TIDIES UP YOUR TEXT)

This is a free, well-known tool that runs small AI models on your own Mac. Whisper Flow uses it to clean up filler words and punctuation — still all on your machine, no internet involved.

Download and open Ollama

Go to ollama.com/download/mac and click

Download for macOS

. Open the downloaded file and drag the Ollama icon into your Applications folder, then open Ollama from there. A small llama icon appears near the top-right of your screen (menu bar) — leave it running.

Download the language model (one-time, ~2GB)

Open

Terminal

: press  Space, type Terminal, press Enter. Paste the line below in (right-click → Paste, or  V) and press Enter:

```
ollama pull llama3.2:3b
```

It'll show a progress bar. Once it says success, this step is done for good — you won't need Terminal again after this.

3 DOWNLOAD AND INSTALL WHISPER FLOW

Get the app

[Download Whisper Flow](#)

Double-click the downloaded `WhisperFlow.zip` to unzip it, then drag `WhisperFlow.app` into your

Applications

folder.

First time only: macOS will warn you

This app isn't from the App Store, so macOS shows a warning the first time. Here's how to open it anyway:

- **Control-click**
(or right-click) `WhisperFlow.app` in Applications, then choose **Open**
- A dialog appears saying it's from an unidentified developer — click **Open** again

You only need to do this once. After that it opens normally.

4 GRANT TWO PERMISSIONS

macOS will ask for these the first time you use it — both are required for Whisper Flow to work.

Accessibility

Lets Whisper Flow "type" your words into whatever app you're using, and listen for your hotkey. A prompt appears on first launch — click

Open System Settings

and turn the toggle on for Whisper Flow. (If you miss it, click the mic icon in your menu bar → Grant Accessibility...)

Microphone

Needed so it can hear you. A normal "Whisper Flow would like to access the Microphone" prompt appears the first time you dictate — click

Allow

.

5 HOW TO USE IT

Quick dictation (hold to talk)

Click where you want the text to go, then

hold down

Right ⌥ Option (the Option key on the right of the spacebar) and speak.

Release the key

when you're done — your cleaned-up text is typed right where your cursor was.

Hands-free (for longer dictation)

Press **⌘ Command** + **Right ⌥ Option** together and let go — it keeps listening even after you release the keys. A small pill at the bottom of the screen shows it's still listening.

Press any key

when you're done to insert the text, or **esc** to cancel without typing anything. (Tip: you can also just hold Right Option and add **⌘** partway through if you decide you need more time — it switches to hands-free without losing what you've said so far.)

Where did the app go?

Whisper Flow lives in your

menu bar

(top of the screen, next to the clock/wifi icons) — not the Dock. Click the mic icon there any time to check it's running or see status. It starts automatically every time you log in (you can turn that off from the same menu).

Questions or something not working? Message Niall directly — this is a new tool, so early feedback is genuinely useful.

Whisper Flow runs entirely on your own Mac. Your voice and your text never leave your machine — nothing is uploaded, logged externally, or sent to any company, including VERVE. ← [Back to Flow](#)